

AETHER WIRELESS · KNOWLEDGE BASE

Customer Verification Policy

Category B — Policy & Process Knowledge Base

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Company	Aether Wireless
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Overview

This policy establishes the requirements and procedures for verifying customer identity before allowing access to account information or executing account actions. All Aether Wireless retail associates, customer care representatives, and digital service channels must comply with these verification standards to protect customer accounts from unauthorized access, identity theft, and fraud. This policy applies to all customer-facing channels including retail stores, phone support, online portals, and mobile applications.

When Verification Is Required

Verification is required before processing any of the following account actions:

- Plan changes or upgrades
- Device financing applications or agreements
- Device pickup or in-store exchanges
- Request for personal data or account records
- Password or PIN resets
- Transferring service to another account or carrier
- Unblocking suspended lines
- Adding or removing account users
- Changing account billing information
- SIM card replacements
- International roaming activation

Verification Methods by Channel

The following table outlines the accepted verification methods for each customer interaction channel. All methods must be completed in full before proceeding with any account action.

Channel	Verification Method	Additional Requirements
In-Store	Two (2) government-issued photo IDs OR biometric verification via registered device	Must be account holder present; secondary ID must be from different issuing authority
Phone	Security PIN plus two (2) correct security question answers	PIN must match account records; questions must be pre-registered on account
Online Portal / Mobile App	One-time passcode (OTP) sent via SMS to registered phone number	OTP valid for 5 minutes; account holder only
Authorized User (In-Store)	Primary account holder pre-authorization code plus user government ID	Authorization must be current (within 24 hours)

Account Holder Only Actions

The following actions require verification from the primary account holder exclusively and cannot be completed by authorized users:

- Removing authorized users from the account
- Closing the account entirely
- Transferring account ownership
- Changing the primary account holder
- Requesting account deletion or data purge

Exceptions and Special Cases

Verified Employees

Aether Wireless employees who have completed internal identity verification may have streamlined verification for their personal accounts when calling customer care. Employees must declare their employment status at the beginning of the call and provide their employee ID number. Employee verification does not bypass security PIN requirements.

Authorized Users

Authorized users on an account may complete most account actions except those listed under Account Holder Only Actions. Authorized users must present their own government-issued photo ID in store or complete phone verification using their registered security information. The primary account holder may grant or revoke authorized user permissions at any time.

Minors on Family Accounts

Minors listed on a family account may not request account changes or access account information without the primary account holder present or explicitly authorized. In-store requests involving minor account holders require either:

- The primary account holder present with valid ID, OR
- A written authorization from the primary account holder (email or in-app) plus the minor's government ID

Customer care representatives must verify the primary account holder's identity before accepting any authorization from a minor on the account.

Failed Attempts and Account Lockout

When a customer fails to verify their identity, the following lockout rules apply:

1. After three (3) failed verification attempts within a single session, the account or channel access is locked for thirty (30) minutes.
2. The lockout timer begins immediately upon the third failed attempt.
3. During lockout, no verification attempts may be made.
4. After the thirty (30) minute period expires, the customer may attempt verification again.
5. If the account is locked due to suspected fraudulent activity, the lockout extends to sixty (60) minutes and a fraud alert is automatically generated.
6. Retail associates must not attempt to override or bypass the lockout under any circumstances.

Logging and Record Retention

All verification attempts, whether successful or failed, must be logged in the customer's account record with the following information:

- Date and time of verification attempt
- Channel used (in-store, phone, online, app)
- Verification method attempted
- Outcome (success/failure)
- Associate or system ID who processed the request
- IP address or device identifier for digital channels

Verification logs are retained for twenty-four (24) months from the date of the verification event. Logs are stored securely and accessible only to authorized Customer Operations and Security personnel.

Suspected Fraud Escalation

When verification attempts reveal suspicious activity, associates must escalate immediately to a supervisor and the Fraud Prevention team. Indicators triggering escalation include:

- Multiple failed verification attempts from different devices or locations
- Customer unable to answer security questions despite correct PIN
- Requests for large data exports or account closures immediately after password resets
- Signs of identity manipulation on presented IDs
- Customer behavior inconsistent with account history (unusual locations, timing, or request patterns)

The Fraud Prevention team may be reached at 1-800-555-0199 or fraud@aetherwireless.com. Associates must not disclose fraud investigation procedures to the customer.

FAQs

Q: Can an authorized user change the account's billing address?

A: Yes, authorized users with verified identity may update billing addresses and other account information unless the primary account holder has restricted this permission. To restrict authorized user permissions, the

primary account holder must contact customer care.

Q: What happens if a customer's registered phone number is no longer accessible for OTP delivery?

A: The customer must contact customer care to update their registered phone number. This requires verification through an alternative method, such as answering security questions or providing account billing information plus a government ID at a retail location.

Q: Can a customer designate a temporary authorized user for a single in-store transaction?

A: Yes, the primary account holder may generate a time-limited authorization code through their online account or mobile app. This code is valid for one (1) in-store transaction within twenty-four (24) hours of creation. The temporary user must present a government-issued photo ID.

Q: Are there circumstances where verification can be bypassed for expedite shipping of a replacement device?

A: No. All device shipments require identity verification. For replacement devices, the account holder must verify via the online portal, app, or phone before the shipment is processed. No exceptions apply.

Q: How long does a fraud alert remain on an account?

A: Fraud alerts remain active for ninety (90) days unless removed earlier by the Fraud Prevention team. During this period, additional verification requirements may apply to account actions.

For questions about this policy, contact Customer Operations at 1-800-555-0000 or email policy-support@aetherwireless.com.